NOAA • AOC • SED N42RF AVAPS DROP LOG

Project: Hurricane 2018 Mission: Owcs '21 Lead Tech: Mike Mascaro

Take Off : 1700Z Landing: Flight ID: 20210213H1

Flt Dir : J. Carpenter

Drop #	Sonde Serial #	Rcvr #	Press Offset	Launch Time	Operator	Charge $$ To	Comments	Good ?
1	194840001	1	-0.5	1959	MAC	AOC	SFMR cal	✓
2								
3								
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Drop #	Sonde Serial #	Rcvr #	Press Offset	Launch Time	Operator	Charge $$ To	Comments	Good ?
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Drop Station Operator Notes

Charge $$ To Options: AOC, NWS, [redacted], SAT (Special NESDIS/HRD), IR/SST or HRD ONLY – Do not use funding codes!!!

AVAPS Pre-Flight Check:

- If time-permits, verify cabin pressure sensor w/ lab standard
- Start AVAPS., then start Soundings and set the Project Name and full Flight ID (example 2015011811).
- Update the Frequency band allocation as required:
  Band A - W53rd, Band B - N42RF, Band C - N43RF, Band D - N49RF, Band E - not allocated
- Perform a prelaunch check on each channel, look for reasonable data and no CRC error status lights. Verify data is available on Remote AVAPS at the FD Station, then terminate the sonde by selecting **Abort** to cancel the sonde initialization. Verify the AVAPS Data mission folder has been created.
- Verify AVAPS PC Time is correct
- Early launch detects are caused usually by remanufactured sondes with the chute riser line not properly coiled between the PCB ears. This may also cause fast falls. If this is suspected, repack the riser line as time permits
- Eyewall drop performance is improved when using sondes manufactured after 7/2016
- Perform RH Regeneration on all sondes – this must be done prior to sonde initialization -

AVAPS Launch:

- Select a sonde frequency in the Green band and away from other sondes
- Enter sonde pressure error offset. The latest AVAPS inserts a default offset value. Adjust if pressure offset is 0.4 mB or greater
- If the Cal lab pressure standard and the cabin pressure standard match, apply pressure offset +/- 0.1 mB
- Select "begin data collection" and verify good data (including Winds) prior to putting sonde in launch tube
- Failure to keep good lock on GPS is likely due to the GPS antenna connector on the sonde PCB needing to be rotated away from surface mount components – do this if needed.
- Cut off about ½ of ribbon, loosen ribbon and extend end of ribbon to near, but not over, the sensor end of the sonde
- Place the sonde in the launch tube, sensor arm up, with the power pin socket facing starboard
- Verify the sonde is actively tracking GPS data prior to launch and no Early Launch detect

NOAA • AOC • SED N42RF AVAPS DROP LOG Lead Tech: Mike Mascaro

Project: Hurricane 2018 Mission: OWW '21 Alaska Flight ID: 20210225H1

Take Off : 0030 Landing: _____ Flt Dir : J. Carpenter / M. Holmes

Drop #	Sonde Serial #	Rcvr #	Press Offset	Launch Time	Operator	Charge $$ To	Comments	Good ?
1	192620160	1	-0.5	0403Z	MAC	AOC	DROP 1 / SFMR verif.	✓
2	191930499	2	Ø					
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Drop #	Sonde Serial #	Rcvr #	Press Offset	Launch Time	Operator	Charge $$ To	Comments	Good ?
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Drop Station Operator Notes

Charge $$ To Options: AOC, NWS, [redacted], SAT (Special NESDIS/HRD), IR/SST or HRD ONLY – Do not use funding codes!!!

AVAPS Pre-Flight Check:

- If time-permits, verify cabin pressure sensor w/ lab standard
- Start AVAPS., then start Soundings and set the Project Name and full Flight ID (example 20150118I1).
- Update the Frequency band allocation as required:
  Band A - W53rd, Band B - N42RF, Band C - N43RF, Band D - N49RF, Band E - not allocated
- Perform a prelaunch check on each channel, look for reasonable data and no CRC error status lights. Verify data is available on Remote AVAPS at the FD Station, then terminate the sonde by selecting **Abort** to cancel the sonde initialization. Verify the AVAPS Data mission folder has been created.
- Verify AVAPS PC Time is correct
- Early launch detects are caused usually by remanufactured sondes with the chute riser line not properly coiled between the PCB ears. This may also cause fast falls. If this is suspected, repack the riser line as time permits
- Eyewall drop performance is improved when using sondes manufactured after 7/2016
- Perform RH Regeneration on all sondes – this must be done prior to sonde initialization -

AVAPS Launch:

- Select a sonde frequency in the Green band and away from other sondes
- Enter sonde pressure error offset. The latest AVAPS inserts a default offset value. Adjust if pressure offset is 0.4 mB or greater
- If the Cal lab pressure standard and the cabin pressure standard match, apply pressure offset +/- 0.1 mB
- Select "begin data collection" and verify good data (including Winds) prior to putting sonde in launch tube
- Failure to keep good lock on GPS is likely due to the GPS antenna connector on the sonde PCB needing to be rotated away from surface mount components – do this if needed.
- Cut off about ½ of ribbon, loosen ribbon and extend end of ribbon to near, but not over, the sensor end of the sonde
- Place the sonde in the launch tube, sensor arm up, with the power pin socket facing starboard
- Verify the sonde is actively tracking GPS data prior to launch and no Early Launch detect

NOAA • AOC • SED N42RF AVAPS DROP LOG Lead Tech: Mike Mascaro

Project: Hurricane 2018 Mission: GWO '21 Flight ID: 20210228H1

Take Off : 1930Z Landing: _____ Flt Dir : J. Carpenter

Drop #	Sonde Serial #	Rcvr #	Press Offset	Launch Time	Operator	Charge $$ To	Comments	Good ?
1	192750292	1	-0.6	1804	MAC	NESDIS		✓
2	191930499	2	+0.2	2001	MAC	AOC		✓
3	191930423	3	+0.3	2015	MAC	NESDIS		
4	191930456	4	+0.1	2017	MAC	NESDIS		
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Drop #	Sonde Serial #	Rcvr #	Press Offset	Launch Time	Operator	Charge $$ To	Comments	Good ?
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Drop Station Operator Notes

Charge $$ To Options: AOC, NWS, [redacted], SAT (Special NESDIS/HRD), IR/SST or HRD ONLY – Do not use funding codes!!!

AVAPS Pre-Flight Check:

- If time-permits, verify cabin pressure sensor w/ lab standard
- Start AVAPS., then start Soundings and set the Project Name and full Flight ID (example 20150118I1).
- Update the Frequency band allocation as required:
  Band A - W53rd, Band B - N42RF, Band C - N43RF, Band D - N49RF, Band E - not allocated
- Perform a prelaunch check on each channel, look for reasonable data and no CRC error status lights. Verify data is available on Remote AVAPS at the FD Station, then terminate the sonde by selecting **Abort** to cancel the sonde initialization. Verify the AVAPS Data mission folder has been created.
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- Cut off about ½ of ribbon, loosen ribbon and extend end of ribbon to near, but not over, the sensor end of the sonde
- Place the sonde in the launch tube, sensor arm up, with the power pin socket facing starboard
- Verify the sonde is actively tracking GPS data prior to launch and no Early Launch detect